

GENERAL ENGLISH (IDIOMS & PHRASES SERIES)

PRACTICE SHEET HARD LEVEL (SET 2) / ADVANCED IDIOMS & MEANINGS (30 QUESTIONS)

1. What is the meaning of the idiom: "An apple of discord"

- (A) A subject or cause of dispute, envy, or rivalry
- (C) A rare horticultural variety grown in ancient orchards

- (B) A contaminated piece of fruit causing widespread illness
- (D) A symbolic offering given during peace treaty negotiations

2. What is the meaning of the idiom: "At loggerheads"

- (A) Engaged in a stubborn dispute or fierce disagreement
- (C) Sailing vessels caught in violent oceanic squalls

- (B) Confused by conflicting navigational instructions
- (D) Working cooperatively on complex maritime projects

3. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Back-seat driver"

- (A) Someone who offers unwanted advice or tries to control a situation from behind
- (C) An automotive engineer testing autopilot navigation software

- (B) A licensed chauffeur operating luxury sedan vehicles
- (D) A backseat passenger sleeping during long road trips

4. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Bite the bullet"

- (A) To force oneself to endure an unpleasant or painful situation
- (C) To react aggressively when provoked by political rivals

- (B) To consume hard ammunition during military survival drills
- (D) To accept a financial loss without demanding compensation

5. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Burn one's bridges"

- (A) To destroy relationships, connections, or paths to return irrevocably
- (C) To sever financial ties with venture capital investors

- (B) To commit arson against municipal engineering infrastructure
- (D) To isolate oneself from society during personal crises

6. What is the meaning of the idiom: "By the skin of one's teeth"

- (A) By a very narrow margin; barely escaping disaster
- (C) Utilizing dishonest shortcuts to pass examinations

- (B) Through extreme physical endurance and athletic training
- (D) Relying entirely on luck rather than professional skill

7. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cast pearls before swine"

- (A) To offer something valuable to someone who cannot appreciate its worth
- (C) To distribute wealth indiscriminately among impoverished populations

- (B) To waste luxury ornaments on agricultural livestock
- (D) To perform noble deeds in front of ungrateful audiences

8. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Chimerical scheme"

- (A) Existing only as the product of unchecked imagination; fantastically improbable
- (C) A complex architectural blueprint designed for skyscrapers

- (B) A brilliant scientific breakthrough published in journals
- (D) A sophisticated corporate restructuring master plan

9. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cry wolf"

- (A) To raise a false alarm, thereby losing credibility when real danger occurs
- (C) To mourn publicly over catastrophic financial losses

- (B) To complain loudly about minor physical discomforts
- (D) To provoke aggressive retaliation from powerful adversaries

10. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cut to the chase"

- (A) To get straight to the point without wasting time on preliminaries
- (C) To edit action sequences out of feature-length films

- (B) To pursue fleeing suspects through crowded urban streets
- (D) To accelerate production timelines before corporate deadlines

11. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Dark horse"	
(A) A little-known competitor who unexpectedly wins or achieves prominence	(B) An undercover agent infiltrating criminal syndicates
(C) A mysterious equestrian racer with unknown pedigree	(D) A political candidate supported by extremist factions
12. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Dog in the manger"	
(A) Someone who prevents others from using something they cannot use themselves	(B) A cruel caretaker mistreating animals on agricultural farms
(C) A selfish business owner hoarding resources from employees	(D) An aggressive watchdog guarding corporate real estate
13. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Eighth wonder"	
(A) Something extraordinary, magnificent, or unprecedented in nature	(B) An ancient archaeological ruin discovered recently
(C) A monumental architectural failure costing billions	(D) A legendary natural phenomenon occurring rarely
14. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Feather in one's cap"	
(A) An achievement to be proud of; a notable distinction	(B) A decorative accessory worn during military parades
(C) A symbolic promotion granted to junior executives	(D) A financial bonus awarded for exceptional performance
15. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Fly in the ointment"	
(A) A minor drawback or annoyance that spoils an otherwise pleasant situation	(B) A chemical contaminant found in pharmaceutical creams
(C) An unexpected obstacle halting construction projects	(D) A structural flaw ruining an artistic masterpiece
16. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Gall and wormwood"	
(A) Source of extreme bitterness, resentment, or deep humiliation	(B) Toxic botanical poisons used in ancient assassinations
(C) Unpleasant medicinal herbs prescribed for fevers	(D) Harsh insults exchanged during political debates
17. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Gild the lily"	
(A) To adorn something unnecessarily or try to improve what is already perfect	(B) To apply gold plating onto inexpensive metallic artifacts
(C) To exaggerate financial profits in corporate earnings reports	(D) To spend lavishly on luxury floral decorations
18. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Halcyon days"	
(A) A period of idyllic peace, prosperity, and happy memories	(B) Long summer vacation breaks enjoyed by students
(C) Calm meteorological conditions at sea during autumn	(D) Economic boom periods experienced by industrialized nations
19. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Iron hand in a velvet glove"	
(A) Firm, unyielding authority masked by a polite or gentle exterior	(B) A dictator ruling nations through tyrannical suppression
(C) Protective garments worn by industrial metalworkers	(D) Diplomatic negotiations backed by military threats
20. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Leap in the dark"	
(A) A hazardous venture undertaken with complete uncertainty of outcome	(B) A nocturnal parachute jump conducted by special forces
(C) A speculative investment made without financial auditing	(D) A reckless decision made during emotional distress

21. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Lion's share"

- (A) The largest and best portion of a shared resource
(C) Corporate dividends distributed among senior executives

- (B) The hunting spoils captured by dominant predators
(D) The majority vote won by incumbent politicians

22. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Mare's nest"

- (A) A false discovery or illusory illusion that appears important at first
(C) A stable housing shelter built for breeding horses

- (B) A chaotic workplace environment lacking organization
(D) A complicated bureaucratic puzzle stalling legislation

23. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Oil on troubled waters"

- (A) An action taken to soothe anger, pacify disputes, or restore harmony
(C) Bribes paid to silence protesting labor unions

- (B) A chemical spill polluting marine coastal environments
(D) Diplomatic talks failing to resolve international conflicts

24. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Pass the buck"

- (A) To shift responsibility or blame onto someone else
(C) To transfer financial assets across offshore accounts

- (B) To gamble money during high-stakes poker matches
(D) To delegate administrative duties to junior staff

25. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Pyrrhic victory"

- (A) A win achieved at such a devastating cost that it amounts to defeat
(C) A championship title stripped due to doping violations

- (B) A brilliant military strategy executed by ancient generals
(D) A courtroom verdict won through technical loopholes

26. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Rest on one's laurels"

- (A) To become complacent and stop striving after past success
(C) To celebrate career milestones with grand banquets

- (B) To retire from professional sports after winning championships
(D) To sleep soundly after completing difficult projects

27. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Salt of the earth"

- (A) A person of great reliability, honesty, and fundamental goodness
(C) Miners extracting mineral resources from subterranean deposits

- (B) Agricultural laborers working on rural plantations
(D) Founders of charitable organizations assisting the poor

28. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Take the bull by the horns"

- (A) To confront a difficult situation directly and courageously
(C) To seize control of corporate leadership by force

- (B) To participate in dangerous rodeo sports events
(D) To wrestle with aggressive political opponents

29. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Throw down the gauntlet"

- (A) To issue a formal challenge or provoke an opponent into a contest
(C) To discard heavy protective gear on battlefields

- (B) To surrender unconditionally during military conflicts
(D) To reject partnership offers from corporate rivals

30. What is the meaning of the idiom: "White elephant"

- (A) A possession that is useless, expensive to maintain, or troublesome
(C) An extravagant gift given during holiday celebrations

- (B) A rare albino animal protected in royal sanctuaries
(D) An obsolete computer system used in government offices

ANSWER KEY (Q1 - Q30)

Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans
1	(A)	6	(A)	11	(A)	16	(A)	21	(A)	26	(A)
2	(A)	7	(A)	12	(A)	17	(A)	22	(A)	27	(A)
3	(A)	8	(A)	13	(A)	18	(A)	23	(A)	28	(A)
4	(A)	9	(A)	14	(A)	19	(A)	24	(A)	29	(A)
5	(A)	10	(A)	15	(A)	20	(A)	25	(A)	30	(A)